

Question:

An 85 years old man underwent transurethral resection of prostate. A histological examination of his specimen showed T1a stage of adenocarcinoma: management will be:

Answer Choices:

A. Endocrine therapy

B. Radical surgery

C. Hormone therapy

D. No further treatment

Reasoning + Answer:

For an 85-year-old man with T1a stage adenocarcinoma of the prostate, the primary factors to consider are the stage of cancer, the patient's age, and his overall health.

1. **Stage of Cancer**: T1a indicates a very early stage of prostate cancer, which means the cancer is confined to a small area within the prostate gland and has not spread to nearby tissues or lymph nodes.

2. **Patient's Age and Health**: The patient is 85 years old, which is an advanced age. At this age, the risk of complications from major surgery (like radical prostatectomy) is higher, and the potential benefits might be outweighed by the risks.

3. **Risk of Recurrence**: T1a stage prostate cancer has a very low risk of recurrence, often less than 10% over 20 years, and many patients with this stage do not require immediate intervention.

4. **Watchful Waiting**: Given the low risk of progression and the patient's advanced age, watchful waiting or active surveillance is often recommended. This involves regular monitoring of the cancer with PSA testing, digital rectal exams, and possibly repeat biopsies.

5. **Endocrine Therapy**: This is typically used for more advanced stages of prostate cancer, such as T3 or T4, where the cancer has spread beyond the prostate gland. T1a stage cancer does not usually require endocrine therapy.

6. **No Further Treatment**: In some cases, particularly in elderly patients with very early-stage cancer, no further treatment may be recommended if the cancer is not causing symptoms and is unlikely to cause significant harm.

Given these considerations, the most appropriate management for a patient with T1a stage adenocarcinoma of the prostate, especially an elderly patient, is typically watchful waiting or active surveillance.

<answer>

A. No further treatment

</answer>

1.5

1.0

0.5

0.0

-0.5

-1.0

-1.5